

Social networking overdrive

From teenagers scrapping and poking, to a useful enterprise tool, social networking has come a long way

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Today, social networking isn't just about reconnecting with old friends – it's a powerful medium of communication for personal use, business communication and entertainment.

There're many who simply go online to access their social network. However, with the API out, several users prefer

like Seesmic Desktop. The client runs on Adobe Air, and you can download it from www.seesmic.com. Though it also has a web counterpart called Seesmic Web, the Desktop client seamlessly integrates Facebook and Twitter allowing you to update and keep track of others. It allows for multiple accounts, profile views, and other time-saving features like auto-complete.

While on the topic of Twitter, the other extremely popular Twitter client

is TweetDeck. Again built using Adobe AIR, it also allows multiple account management, and features quite similar to Seesmic. TweetDeck also allows you to update your LinkedIn status, besides displaying local trends.

Interesting functions with tools such as Power include search and automatic URL shortening. They also have their own respective photo integration that allows you to

instantly upload photos and

provide links. The drawback about having Twitter clients with Facebook integration is that most users link their Facebook and Twitter updates, so you usually end up seeing redundant updates.

Mac users have the option of Tweetie for Mac or the Mac Lounge among other desktop clients for Twitter. Tweepie should also try out Brizzly (www.brizzly.com). It has nice features such as grouping and an interesting mute

feature where you can mute those whose updates you temporarily don't care about (for example, someone live tweeting a conference you have no interest in). You can also update Facebook from the same interface.

On the desktop front, Scrapboy is quite useful. It links Orkut and Facebook (among others) and allows you to access your groups, see updates, and browse walls/scrapbooks. Apart from instant notifications, a useful stealth mode, it also has a P2P option allowing you to exchange files with friends. It's a 7.6 MB download available from www.scrapboy.com.

Facebook has also launched an official application called the Facebook Desktop for Adobe AIR. The good part is that it merely serves as a browser for Facebook. So you can use all of Facebook's features without opening your browser. Another cool desktop application is the Facebook – Photo Uploader launched by Adobe, and allows you to chat and upload photos.

Among Desktop Clients, however, Digsby steals the cake. For those who use social networking primarily to stay in touch, the multiple IM client also has social networking options. Apart from integrating MSN, Yahoo!, GTalk and Facebook Chat (among others) and

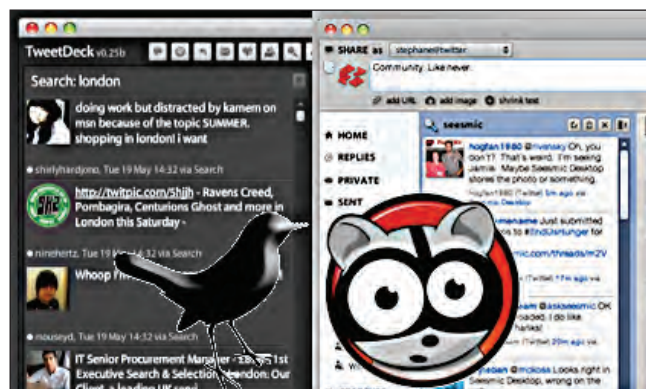


You'll never be done counting the number of networking sites online!

desktop clients. A web browser can be extremely distracting. For those who're on the go, sites such as Twitter and Facebook have mobile versions that can be easily accessed on your mobile internet browser.

The iPhone, of course, offers a wide range of applications for the same. The other ways you could connect is through your web browser, your IM client, and your homepage (read iGoogle or similar).

If you insist on using the web but find it too cumbersome to access, www.power.com gives you a one-stop destination through which you can access Orkut, Twitter and LinkedIn. It also allows you to access hi5 and MySpace. Desktop users would prefer something



Seesmic Desktop vs. TweetDeck